👩‍🏫 Staff Guide · Ag Science 1 · Ag Words & Whatcom Farms (Level 3)

Level 3 = resource-room students who can work close to the gen ed lesson. Same topics and order as Mr. Torretta's class; more reading and writing than Level 2.

1. How the pieces line up

Class lesson	Level 3 piece
Ag Terms (Top 50)	Reading parts 1-3; notes section A
WA Farm Bureau Ag Statistics	Reading part 4; notes section B
Farming for Life brochure + video	Reading part 5; notes section C
Whatcom Ag Businesses slides; Tour de Whatcom	Notes section C short answers; quick check + unit game

2. Supports built in

- Reading and notes each have a web copy with a 🔊 Read aloud button (highlights as it reads)
- Key-word box at the top of the notes; word problems have a worked example first
- Less filled in than Level 2: short answers, tables, a drawing
- No slide decks: students follow Mr. Torretta's slides with the Level 3 notes

3. Files

- Reading (+ 🔊 web copy)
- Guided notes + key (+ 🔊 web copy)
- Quick check + key
- Unit game: 10 questions

4. What to grade

- Guided notes stand in for the matching class notes or worksheet (same points when complete)
- Quick check: score it, then scale to the class quiz points
- Reading check questions: completion points
- Modified grading only as the IEP allows. Check with the case manager.

5. Who to ask

- Mr. Driver (SLE): changes and IEP questions.
- Class content: Mr. Torretta.

🌾 Ag Words & Whatcom Farms: Guided Notes

Ag Science 1 · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Ag Literacy: Ag Terms (Top 50), Farming for Life, WA Farm Bureau statistics, Whatcom Ag Businesses, Tour de Whatcom

Name: _____

Use the class slides and your reading. Key words:

agriculture · *agribusiness* · *organic* · *topsoil* · *erosion* · *crop rotation* · *herbicide* · *precision ag* · *export* · *import*

A. Ag terms (Top 50)

1. Fill in the table.

Term	Meaning
Fertilizer	
Pesticide	
Herbicide	
Compost	

2. Planting different crops in turns is crop _____.

3. Legumes add _____ to the soil.

B. Washington agriculture (Farm Bureau)

4. Washington grows about _____ crops.

5. Washington's #1 farm product is _____.

6. Why is Washington agriculture important to the state? Use one number.

_____

_____

C. Whatcom County (Farming for Life, Tour de Whatcom)

7. Whatcom leads Washington in red _____.

8. Why does protecting farmland matter? Give two reasons.

_____

_____

9. Pick one Whatcom ag business. What does it do and what jobs does it have?

_____

_____

🌾 Ag Words & Whatcom Farms: Reading

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Name: _____

Agriculture Close to Home

Agriculture is the science and practice of growing crops and raising animals for food, fiber and other products. Agribusiness includes the farming, processing and selling of those products, from a feed store to a veterinarian. Organic farms grow food without synthetic pesticides or fertilizers.

Healthy farms start with healthy soil. Topsoil is the top layer, where most roots grow, and erosion wears it away. Farmers protect it with crop rotation, planting different crops in turns. Legumes like beans and peas add nitrogen to the soil. Farmers also use fertilizer and compost to feed plants, pesticides to control pests and herbicides to control weeds.

Technology changes farming. A combine harvests, threshes and cleans grain in one pass. Precision agriculture uses GPS, drones and sensors. Hydroponics grows plants in nutrient water with no soil.

Washington grows about 300 crops, second only to California in variety. Agriculture adds about $51 billion to the state's economy and supports more than 164,000 jobs. In 2016 the top five products were apples, milk, potatoes, cattle and wheat. Washington exports (sells to other countries) apples, wheat and more, and imports foods like coffee and bananas.

Whatcom County leads the state in red raspberries, grows many blueberries, is a top dairy county, and grows seed potatoes for growers across the West. Whatcom has about 1,582 farms, and most are small. Once farmland is built on, it rarely comes back, so protecting it matters for food, clean water and salmon habitat.

Check your reading

1. What is the difference between a crop and livestock?

2. Name two crops or products Whatcom County is known for.

3. What is an export?

🌾 Ag Words & Whatcom Farms: Quick Check

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Name: _____

Multiple choice and short answer. You may have it read aloud.

1. Agriculture is…

A. Growing crops and raising animals | B. Only selling food | C. Only city gardens

2. An herbicide kills…

A. Insects | B. Cows | C. Weeds

3. Whatcom County leads Washington in…

A. Oranges | B. Cotton | C. Red raspberries

4. Buying coffee from another country is an…

A. Export | B. Import | C. Agribusiness

5. Explain how crop rotation helps soil.

6. Name Washington's top 3 farm products (2016).

🌾 Ag Words & Whatcom Farms: Guided Notes · ANSWER KEY

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Name: _____

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A. Ag terms (Top 50)

1. Fill in the table.

Term	Meaning
Fertilizer	**helps plants grow**
Pesticide	**kills or controls pests**
Herbicide	**kills weeds**
Compost	**decayed plants used as fertilizer**

2. Planting different crops in turns is crop **rotation**.

3. Legumes add **nitrogen** to the soil.

B. Washington agriculture (Farm Bureau)

4. Washington grows about **300** crops.

5. Washington's #1 farm product is **apples**.

6. Why is Washington agriculture important to the state? Use one number.
Example: it adds about $51 billion to the economy / supports 164,000+ jobs.

C. Whatcom County (Farming for Life, Tour de Whatcom)

7. Whatcom leads Washington in red **raspberries**.

8. Why does protecting farmland matter? Give two reasons.
Once built on it rarely returns; farms grow food, keep water clean and protect salmon habitat.

9. Pick one Whatcom ag business. What does it do and what jobs does it have?
Answers vary, e.g., a feed store sells animal feed; jobs: cashier, delivery driver.

🔑 *Key written by our team from Mr. Torretta's materials, please check.*

🌾 Ag Words & Whatcom Farms: Reading · ANSWER KEY

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Name: _____

Agriculture Close to Home

Agriculture is the science and practice of growing crops and raising animals for food, fiber and other products. Agribusiness includes the farming, processing and selling of those products, from a feed store to a veterinarian. Organic farms grow food without synthetic pesticides or fertilizers.

Healthy farms start with healthy soil. Topsoil is the top layer, where most roots grow, and erosion wears it away. Farmers protect it with crop rotation, planting different crops in turns. Legumes like beans and peas add nitrogen to the soil. Farmers also use fertilizer and compost to feed plants, pesticides to control pests and herbicides to control weeds.

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Whatcom County leads the state in red raspberries, grows many blueberries, is a top dairy county, and grows seed potatoes for growers across the West. Whatcom has about 1,582 farms, and most are small. Once farmland is built on, it rarely comes back, so protecting it matters for food, clean water and salmon habitat.

Check your reading

1. What is the difference between a crop and livestock?
A crop is a plant grown on a farm; livestock are animals raised for food, fiber or work.

2. Name two crops or products Whatcom County is known for.
Any two: red raspberries, blueberries, dairy/milk, seed potatoes.

3. What is an export?
A product sent to sell in another country.

🌾 Ag Words & Whatcom Farms: Quick Check · ANSWER KEY

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Multiple choice and short answer. You may have it read aloud.

1. Agriculture is…

A. Growing crops and raising animals | B. Only selling food | C. Only city gardens

2. An herbicide kills…

A. Insects | B. Cows | **C. Weeds**

3. Whatcom County leads Washington in…

A. Oranges | B. Cotton | **C. Red raspberries**

4. Buying coffee from another country is an…

A. Export | **B. Import** | C. Agribusiness

5. Explain how crop rotation helps soil.

Changing crops each season keeps soil healthy; legumes add nitrogen and pests/diseases build up less.

6. Name Washington's top 3 farm products (2016).

Apples, milk, potatoes.

🔑 *Key written by our team from Mr. Torretta's quizzes and notes, please check.*